

Cooper Williams, LHP, LSU

Metrics

SI: 90.0/11.2 IVB/-15.0 HB/-5.93 VAA/5.44 relH/5.83 ext/37.0 AA/44.3% zone/55.4% usage/2110 rpm

CB: 75.0/-10.3 IVB/8.9 HB/-10.05 VAA/54.7 AA/33.3% zone/9.0% usage/2160 rpm

SL: 79.9/0.7 IVB/6.6 HB/-8.14 VAA/47.7 AA/50.6% zone/25.4% usage/2200 rpm

CH: 83.0/4.7 IVB/-15.0 HB/-6.88 VAA/32.1 AA/32.4% zone/10.2% usage/1810 rpm

Write-Up

Williams is a compact left-hander whose profile is built around a heavy sinker and a quality slider. The arsenal generates ground balls at an impressive rate while offering enough swing-and-miss to project in a professional role. While the pure stuff does not consistently overpower hitters, the movement characteristics create uncomfortable contact quality and allow him to attack the lower portion of the strike zone effectively. The profile currently projects more comfortably in relief than in a rotation, though there is enough pitchability and movement diversity to warrant continued development.

The SI serves as the foundation of the arsenal. Averaging 90.0 mph with 15 inches of arm-side movement, the pitch possesses strong sinker traits and consistently produces ground balls when located at the bottom of the zone. The pitch generated modest swing-and-miss numbers but limited quality contact effectively, allowing only a .381 slugging percentage despite heavy usage. The strike-throwing ability is solid and the movement profile should continue generating weak contact at higher levels. The velocity limits the ceiling, but the shape supports a professional role. 40/45+ pitch.

The CB is used sparingly but flashes intriguing upside. The shape combines depth with quality glove-side movement and produced strong swing-and-miss results in a limited sample. The command remains inconsistent and the usage is too small for an aggressive projection, though the movement profile creates a distinctly different look than the slider. 40/50 pitch.

The SL is the best pitch in the arsenal. Thrown nearly 80 mph with quality lateral movement, the pitch generated a 38.1% chase rate, 41.5% whiff rate, and 41.2% CSW. Williams demonstrated confidence

throwing the pitch in leverage counts and consistently landed it for strikes before expanding beneath the zone. The shape projects comfortably to professional baseball and gives him a legitimate bat-missing weapon. 50/55 pitch.

The CH provides another look against opposite-handed hitters and mirrors the sinker effectively. The pitch generated respectable swing-and-miss while maintaining substantial armside movement. The command remains inconsistent, but the movement profile is intriguing and gives him another avenue for generating weak contact. 40/45 pitch.